

Science Students' Association Council Meeting

Date: 2026-10-07

Location: Science Students' Association Lounge (Armes 209)

Chaired By: Reyna Torres, Chairperson

Meeting type: Regular



Attendance

Position	Name	Attendance
President	Noah Crossman	Present
Vice President	Caleb Pereira	Present
Chairperson	Reyna Torres	Present
Secretary	Jason Hong	Present
Senator	Yashsavi Negi	Present
Senator	Hargun Uppal	Absent with regrets
Senator	Kushal Joshi	Absent with regrets
UMSU Director	Danylo Kruk	Present
Director of Student Advocacy	Roopak Brar	Absent with regrets
International Representative	Gurminder Singh	Present
Women's Representative	Zaina Abazid	Present
First Years' Representative	Vacant	Position vacant
Racialized Representative	Vacant	Position vacant
Black Students' Representative	Seun Fatunmbi	Present
2SLGBTQIA+ Representative	Alice Miranda Gislason	Present
Accessibility Representative	Victoria Vong	Present
Indigenous Representative	April Quill	Present
Treasurer	Anshika Sharma	Absent with regrets
Lounge Programmer	Sean Delaney	Present
Executive Assistant	Nick Sarte	Present
External Partnerships Programmer	Hamza Haque	Absent with regrets
Director of Communications	Yeeun Ryu	Absent with regrets
Communications Programmer (Marketing)	Vincenzina Conia	Absent with regrets
Communications Programmer (Marketing)	Imrose Dhaliwal	Absent with regrets
Communications Programmer (Media)	Alix Ganetsky	Absent with regrets
Communications Programmer (Productions)	Hashmeen Kaur	Present
Director of Special Events	Quinn Derksen	Present
Special Events Programmer (Social)	Jayden Gupta	Present

Position	Name	Attendance
Special Events Programmer (Social)	Zenah Large	Absent with regrets
Special Events Programmer (Research)	Fatin Shadab Talukder	Present
Special Events Programmer (Research)	Benjamin Lehman	Present
Director of Student Services	Ian Ogwen	Absent with regrets
Student Services Programmer (Academics)	Erica Wong	Present
Student Services Programmer (Academics)	Mary Lozano	Present
Services Programmer (Operations)	Harsh Kumar	Absent with regrets
Services Programmer (Operations)	Matthew Gray	Absent
Student Services Programmer (Outreach)	Kay Durojaiye	Present

Regrets and Proxies

- Kushal Joshi; Senator
 - Proxy: Jason Hong; Secretary
- Hargun Uppal; Senator
 - Proxy: Nick Sarte Executive Assistant
- Roopak Brar; Director of Student Advocacy
 - Proxy: Fatin Shadab Talukder; Special Events Programmer (Research)
- Anshika Sharma; Treasurer
- Hamza Haque; External Partnerships Programmer
- Vincenzina Conia; Communications Programmer (Marketing)
- Yeeun Ryu; Director of Communications
- Imrose Dhaliwal; Communications Programmer (Marketing)
- Alix Ganetsky; Communications Programmer (Media)
- Zenah Large; Special Events Programmer (Social)
- Ian Ogwen; Director of Student Services
- Harsh Kumar; Student Services Programmer (Operations)
- Matthew Gray; Student Services Programmer (Operations)

Minutes

Call to Order

Chairperson Reyna Torres called the meeting to order at 6:04 p.m.

Approval of Agenda

A motion to approve the agenda was moved by 2SLGBTQIA+ Representative Gislason and seconded by Accessibility Representative Vong. The agenda was approved as as written.

Treaty Land Acknowledgement

Chairperson Reyna Torres read the treaty land acknowledgement of the SSA.

Approval of Previous Meeting Minutes

A motion to approve the previous meeting's minutes was moved by Senator Negi and seconded by President Crossman. The meeting minutes were approved as written.

Reports of Councillors

President and Vice President

- President Crossman and Vice President Pereira summarized the Report of the President and Vice President.
- **Motion P100726A - UM Food Bank support fee:** A motion to provide \$250.00 to the University of Manitoba Food Bank was moved by Noah Crossman, seconded by April Quill, and carried without opposition.
- **Motion P100726B - Purchasing grocery store gift cards:** A motion to purchase \$375.00 in grocery store gift cards was moved by Noah Crossman, seconded by Zaina Abazid, and carried without opposition.

Treasurer [†]

UMSU Director [†]

Senators [†]

Director of Student Advocacy [†]

Indigenous Representative

- Indigenous Representative Quill summarized the Report of the Indigenous Representative.
- **Pumpkin Painting Funding Motion:** April Quill moved a motion to approve \$150.00 in funding for the Pumpkin Painting Hangout event to be held in collaboration with the University 1 Student Council and the University of Manitoba Indigenous Students' Association. Alice Miranda Gislason seconded the motion. The motion was carried without opposition.

International Representative [†]

Accessibility Representative [†]

2SLGBTQIA+ Representative

- 2SLGBTQIA+ Representative Gislason summarized the Report of the Indigenous Representative.

Women's Representative

- Women's Representative Abazid summarized the Report of the Women's Representative.
- **Questions:**
 - Senator Negi asked if the planned Women in Science event on November 19 would conflict with the planned SSA Town Hall event.
 - Student Services Programmer (Outreach) Durojaiye stated that the current planned date for the SSA Town Hall is November 20.

First Years' Representative †

Racialized Representative †

Black Students' Representative †

Communications

- In Director of Communications Ryu's absence, Communications Programmer (Productions) Kaur summarized the Report of the Communications Team.
- **Questions:**
 - Executive Assistant Sarte asked if the QR code to apply for SSA travel and sponsorship funds is out to date.
 - Kaur stated that she will ask the Communications team.
- **Comments:**
 - President Crossman stated that for the SSA Instagram posts displaying upcoming dates where the SSA Lounge is booked for events, it may be preferable to use the term "Lounge booking" opposed to "Lounge closure."

Student Services

- Student Services Programmer (Academics) Wong and Student Services Programmer (Academics) Lozano summarized the Report of the Student Services Team.
- **Discussion:** Wong noted an email received from the Academic Advising office from the Faculty of Engineering asking if the office may recommend the SSA's tutoring program.
 - Wong noted that the SSA tutoring program does not ask students being tutored their faculty or otherwise impose significant restrictions. The primary question to discuss is whether the office should advertise the program.
 - President Crossman asked whether the office indicated how many students would be interested in joining the tutoring program.
 - Wong stated that the office asked only for permission to recommend the program to engineers.
 - Crossman stated that the SSA pays a flat rate for access for the tutoring program, noting that cost would not be an issue, but the main concern would be engineering students occupying spots in the program that would otherwise have gone to science students.
 - Special Events Programmer (Research) Talukder noted that the University of Manitoba Engineering Society (UMES) operates its own program which charges for tutoring.
 - Vice President Pereira stated that while engineering students independently joining the SSA tutoring program is not an issue, it may be undesirable to actively advertise in engineering spaces, as it may encroach on the UMES tutoring program.
 - Pereira asked if UMES offers tutors for science courses, noting that there is no risk of encroaching on the UMES program if there is no overlap in courses offered.
 - Senator Negi stated that UMES does offer tutors for science courses, such as MATH 1500.
 - Negi stated that if the SSA chooses not to allow the office to advertise, it may be preferable to instead recommend the Academic Learning Centre's tutoring program.
 - Pereira stated that it may be worth contacting UMES directly about the matter. Pereira suggested responding to the office's email by stating that the SSA will contact UMES and provide an update upon resolution.

Special Events

- Director of Special Events Derksen summarized the Report of the Special Events team.
- **Comments:**

- ▶ Student Services Programmer (Academics) Lozano stated that she is a member of the Psychology Students Association (PSA) and may assist in helping connect the SSA with the PSA.

Lounge Programmer

- Lounge Programmer Delaney summarized the Report of the Lounge Programmer.
- **Lounge Pool Table Motion:** Danylo Kruk moved a motion to approve in \$157.32 in funding to purchase six leather pool table pockets to repair the SSA Lounge's pool table. Nick Sarte, proxying on behalf of Hargun Uppal, seconded the motion. The motion was carried with one opposition vote by Caleb Pereira.
- **SSA Office Snack Purchase Motion:** Alice Miranda Gislason moved a motion to approve \$240.00 in funding for snacks for the SSA office. Caleb Pereira seconded the motion. The motion was carried without opposition.
- **Discussion:** Councillors briefly discussed preferences for snacks.
- **Questions:**
 - ▶ Senator Negi asked whether Professor Daniel Rea's EDI office hours will be restricted to students in Computer Science or if they will be open to all students.
 - Delaney stated that Rea did not specify, though the office hours will likely be available to all students.

External Partnerships Programmer [†]

Reports of Committees

Executive Committee

- Executive Assistant Sarte summarized the report of the Executive Committee.
- Sarte stated that fifteen groups have been admitted to the Board of Science Student Groups (BOSG) and some additional groups are interested in joining. However, the deadline is quickly approaching and the remaining groups have had issues communicating with UMSU, particularly with regard to club pre-approval and club constitutional amendments. Sarte notes that a lack of UMSU pre-approval is an issue for admission.
- **Discussion:** Sarte asked Councillors if a strict deadline should be set for joining the BOSG, or if the SSA should work with groups on a case-by-case basis to potentially join the BOSG.
 - ▶ Senator Negi asked which of the remaining groups interested in joining the BOSG are departmental groups.
 - Sarte stated that there are five student groups interested in applying to the BOSG who have not yet completed the process. Four are departmental groups: the Biology Undergraduate Students' Association (BUGS), University of Manitoba Statistics Students (UMs2), EigenClub, and Chem Club. One (UMTI) is non-departmental.
 - ▶ Vice President Pereira stated that it would be preferable to give grace to the groups who have made a meaningful effort to join the BOSG, but leniency should not be provided to groups who only begin the process of admission after the deadline has already passed.
 - ▶ UMSU Director Kruk spoke in favour of a strict deadline, stating that he would prefer leniency in a first-time situation, but stated that in the previous academic year he gave significant effort in assisting clubs with UMSU approval and constitutional amendments, stating that clubs should follow the given deadlines.
 - ▶ President Crossman stated that while the remaining groups began the admission process later than what would be ideal, the groups must await a slow process to obtain approval by UMSU, and punishing clubs for this may be undesirable.
 - ▶ Crossman stated that persistent deadline extensions will not solve the issue, and proposed an alternate arrangement in which the remaining groups could obtain tentative admission into the BOSG through

completion of UMSU's required Sexual Violence Prevention Workshop, with a requirement to obtain full UMSU club approval by the end of the Fall semester. Crossman stated that groups with tentative admission should be ineligible for SSA funds until they obtain full admission into the BOSG.

Selections Committee †

Bylaws Committee †

Other Business

- Vice President Pereira provided a notice of motion for two upcoming motions to be moved by the Bylaws Committee. One motion will amend the committee itself, and the other will amend the section on running general elections.
- **Council Meeting Pizza Motion:** Caleb Pereira moved a motion to reimburse himself \$142.28 in pizzas purchased for the present Council meeting. Alice Miranda Gislason seconded the motion. UMSU Director Kruk asked a question about the motion. The motion was carried with one opposition vote from Danylo Kruk.

Final Considerations

- Vice President Pereira stated that for the subsequent Council meeting, it may be desirable to set up the tables in the SSA Lounge further away from Colosimo and place Councillors giving reports closer to the center of the room, as the volume produced by the cafe's fridge made it difficult to hear reports.
- Chairperson Torres stated that it is distracting to speak or have conversations when a Councillor is giving their report.

Adjournment

A motion to adjourn the meeting was moved by Black Students' Representative Fatunmbi and seconded by Vice President Pereira. The motion was adopted without objection and the meeting was adjourned at 7:02 p.m.

Motions

Motion: UM Food Bank support fee (ID: P100726A)

Category: Report of the President and Vice President

WHEREAS SSA is developing its new Grocery Support Program.

WHEREAS SSA will be partnering with the UM Food Bank to provide groceries for students.

WHEREAS the UM Food Bank has requested \$250 to account for the potential influx of students.

BE IT RESOLVED that the SSA commits \$250 to the UM Food Bank to support the SSA Grocery Support Program.

Moved by: Noah Crossman

Seconded by: April Quill

Status: Passed

Motion: Purchasing grocery store gift cards (ID: P100726B)

Category: Report of the President and Vice President

WHEREAS SSA is developing its new Grocery Support Program.

WHEREAS SSA will purchase 5 \$75 gift cards from a local grocery store to distribute to recipients.

BE IT RESOLVED that the SSA commits \$375 to the purchase of 5 grocery store gift cards to support the SSA Grocery Support Program.

Moved by: Noah Crossman

Seconded by: Zaina Abazid

Status: Passed

Motion: Pumpkin Painting Funding Motion

Category: Report of the Indigenous Representative

Approve \$150.00 in funding for the Pumpkin Painting Hangout event.

Moved by: April Quill

Seconded by: Alice Miranda Gislason

Status: Passed

Motion: Lounge Pool Table Motion

Category: Report of the Lounge Programmer

Approve \$157.32 in funding to purchase pool pockets to repair the SSA Lounge's pool table.

Moved by: Danylo Kruk

Seconded by: Nick Sarte

Status: Passed

Motion: SSA Office Snack Purchases

Category: Report of the Lounge Programmer

Approve \$240.00 in funding for snacks for the SSA office.

Moved by: Alice Miranda Gislason

Seconded by: Caleb Pereira

Status: Passed

Motion: Council Meeting Pizza Motion

Category: Other Business

Approve \$142.28 reimbursement to Caleb Pereira for the cost of pizzas purchased for the present Council meeting.

Moved by: pereira

Seconded by: Alice Miranda Gislason

Status: Passed